

Vervet monkey

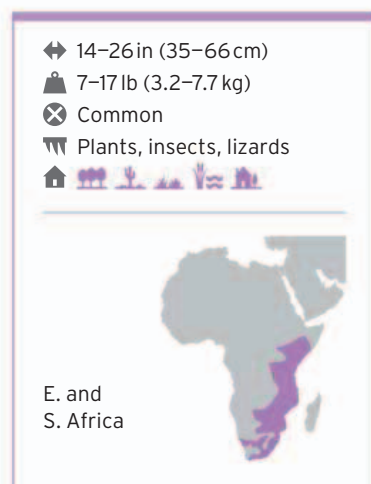
Chlorocebus pygerythrus

Africa's most widespread monkey, vervets thrive in a variety of environments. They prefer scrub forests bordering rivers, but are found in habitats as diverse as semidesert and swamp, from sea level to altitudes up to 14,750 ft (4,500 m). Vervets eat all plant parts, from root to fruit, but also feed on insects, lizards, eggs, and small mammals. However, their appetite for sweet potatoes and bananas often brings them into conflict with farmers.

United we stand

A highly social species, vervets travel, feed, drink, groom, and rest in troops of as few as seven or as many as 75 individuals. Adult females rule the troop, which includes a smaller number of males (with their own hierarchy), juveniles, and offspring. While females stay with their troops for life, males leave at around age five, often in twos or threes to avoid an attack by a high-status female. They transfer mainly during the mating season (April to June), when dominant females are less prone to attack them.

Vervet monkeys have **specific vocal warnings** for **specific predators**



△ **SHARP AS A KNIFE**
Adult male vervets have longer canines than females. They reveal them in dominance displays and will use them as a weapon.

◁ **INHERITED RANK**
High-status females receive the best of everything, from food to sleeping trees, and their offspring inherit this status.